

Casio EXILIM Z-90

Features

- Resolution: 12.1 megapixels
- Optical zoom: 3x optical zoom
- LCD screen: 6.9 cm (2.7 inches)
- HD video recording: Yes

Price
₹ 8995



₹ 6000, while its camcorders start from ₹ 14,000. Sony handycams start from ₹ 14,990, while its digital camera range starts from as low as ₹ 6490.

When is either of them preferable?

Digital camera is a compact device that fulfils your routine photo imaging needs. It is easy to carry, even simpler to use and has multipurpose utility. More so, it is easier on the pocket than a camcorder.

A dedicated sensor and image processor that are designed to process digital still images, built-in flash and various shooting modes like macro, best shot selector, smile and blink warning lead to results that are usually much better than the stills captured by dedicated digital camcorders.

At many places, like museums, still shooting is allowed, but video shooting is either chargeable or prohibited. Shooting stills with a camcorder may not be allowed at many tourist spots due to regulations. Also, for everyday use, large camcorders may prove too bulky to carry around.

However, a camcorder has no substitute when it comes to longer-duration video recording. Camcorders are designed to be held steady for longer periods of time, using both of your hands or a tripod stand. For movie recording up to two-three hours, compact cameras are of no use.

A camcorder records excellent video even in difficult light conditions. It captures a memorable moment with the actual sound and voices, which no still camera can replicate.

So if you wish for higher-resolution, higher-quality videos with more

capabilities like higher zoom and colour-correction modes, a camcorder is perfect. It is all about convenience.

How good are camcorders at stills?

With increase in the digital zoom, the megapixel resolution goes down. So camcorders, which have a large digital zoom but resolution as small as 0.8 MP, cannot take good-quality still images. These are designed for a low resolution also because you see the video generally on a low-resolution TV screen.

Higher resolutions are possible for stills but the cost of the camcorder goes up significantly; e.g., a camcorder with a resolution of 3.1 MP could cost up to ₹ 40,000. Sony's 12MP camcorder (Handycam) costs nearly ₹ 60,000.

The technology used in a digital camcorder is optimised for processing video images. The sensors used for capturing still images, though nowadays offering high resolutions (12 megapixels in some models), are often too small to give the same quality as dedicated digicams.

How good are digicams at video recording?

Digicams are good for both still image capture and short home movie record-

ing. In comparison to camcorders that require settings and arrangements to be done before use, digicams are convenient (click-to-shoot, click-to-stop) and easy to carry.

All new high-end cameras above ₹ 10,000 support an 8-32GB memory card. "With 1GB card, you can record one-hour plus of 480p video, or only 17-18 minutes of HD video. Recording capacity also depends on what you are shooting; colour-rich scenes take more space," says R. Ganesh, general manager-digital capture & devices and film capture, Kodak India.

The videos shot using a digicam are good enough for home viewing under most conditions. There are also various other formats to suit different needs, like shooting videos for the Internet.

Some digital SLR (DSLR) cameras also offer digital video shooting nowadays. Since these cameras use much larger sensors, image quality is very good, although the shooting process suffers from a few drawbacks at present.

Nowadays a new category is coming up in the form of pocket video cameras. These are the size of mobile phones and can record home movies.

How to buy a digicam?

First, lock down the budget at which you would buy your camera. Then decide on the features you need within that budget. Megapixels, zoom, screen size, user-customisable features, battery backup, autofocus and ISO are some of the normally considered features. Also, these days, manufacturers are bullish on ease of use and customised colours. Once you have figured that out, you can consult your peers

Nikon COOLPIX S3000

Features

- Resolution: 12.0 MP
- Optical zoom: 4x
- LCD: 6.9 cm (2.7 inches)

Price
₹ 8950

